

SLOPEWATCH · DESIGN DECISIONS REGISTER

SlopeWatch design decisions register

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

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Project TRL	TRL 3 Proof of concept		
Repository	github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/slopedwatch		
Source	docs/06-design-decisions.md @ uncommitted		

REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.2	2026-10-02	Amish Chadha	Amish approved the recommendations for open decisions 1 to 12 (SLW-DDR-003 accepted); moved to decisions made
0.1	2026-10-01	Amish Chadha	Register opened with the open decisions from the review note, SLW-DDR-001 to SLW-DDR-003 and the build plan work; budget treated as a value-engineering target

SlopeWatch design decisions register

Every design decision still to be made, and every decision made, in one place. Each decision is argued in full in its decision record under `docs/decisions/`; this register is the index Amish works from. The build plan (`docs/05-build-plan.md`) describes the design as it stands and does not list open decisions.

■ Open decisions

None. All open decisions were decided on 2026-10-02.

■ To confirm when parts are bought

#	What to confirm	Why it matters	Source
1	The 1.5 in end cap thread matches the pipe thread (BSP or NPT)	The cap must seal against grout and water	SLW-DDR-003, P2
2	The 110 x 50 mm reducer's 50 mm socket is 50 to 51 mm inside	The tape wrap takes up only about 1 mm a side	SLW-DDR-003, P3
3	The capsule board is at most 28 mm wide and fits the 30 mm bore of the tube	Sets the capsule tube size	SLW-DDR-003, P1
4	The displacement sensor has an M6 rod-end ball joint at each end and a removable plunger-end joint, and its plunger thread fits the coupling	The rod and the ball joints are sized to it	SLW-DDR-003, P5
5	The alert and switch boxes have four corner screw holes outside the lid seal, and their spacing matches the plate holes	The plates are drilled to suit	SLW-DDR-003, P8, P9
6	The horn has a sealing flange and the beacon a gasketed base that cover a 10 mm hole	Keeps the alert box sealed	SLW-DDR-003, P8
7	The conduit fittings' hole size and lock nut size fit inside the 110 mm head	Sets the 20.5 mm holes and the lock nut clearance	SLW-DDR-003, P4
8	The existing pole at the test site, if used, is round, 40 to 70 mm, and sound enough to carry the node and alert unit in wind	The fixing and the wind case depend on it	SLW-CAL-001 [H1]

■ Value engineering

Value-engineering target: USD 250 (a hypothetical control target, not a limit). Estimated cost of the constructable design: USD 296.50 for the SlopeWatch-specific parts of the reference site, node on an existing pole (USD 46.50 over the target); USD 324.50 where the optional mast is needed. The FieldNode core (USD 126) is costed in its own project. Main cost drivers and savings worth trying:

- The largest lines are the three tilt sensor capsules (USD 82.50, mostly the three inclinometers at about USD 18 each), the crack gauge with its reader (USD 46), the alert unit with its switch post (USD 43), the bus cable in conduit (USD 42) and the three stakes (USD 39).
- Making the design constructable added USD 51.50: end caps and stand tubes (USD 12), collars (USD 1.50), stake heads from drainage fittings with conduit fittings and connectors (USD 18), the gauge's clamp blocks, ball

joints, rod coupling, folded guard and pegs (USD 8), the alert and switch mounting plates and clamps (USD 10), and tape and a plug (USD 2).

- Decided on 2026-10-02 and not yet priced: stake head marking (amber paint, retroreflective band, labels), wall holes in both back plates, and, outside the reference site, the 60.3 mm mast for site installations, a second alert unit at sites with running machinery, armoured cable across rockfall zones and an alert unit battery if FieldNode has not rated its 12 V rail.
- Savings worth trying: bury the bus cable without conduit where the ground is soft and stable (up to about USD 15); buy the inclinometers and boards in a batch for several sites; make the guard from offcut sheet; use plain M20 cable glands on the stake heads where the conduit stops short of the head (about USD 2 a stake); price a second-source crack sensor with ball joints included.

■ Decisions made

Date	Decision	Decided by	Record
2026-09-25	TRL 2 review items D1 to D7: FieldNode core costed in FieldNode; tailings dams kept in the pitch with limits; surface tilt stakes plus a crack gauge; wired RS-485 bus; SCL3300 in mode 1; published tilt-rate thresholds and keyed 30 min silence; alert unit at the toe	Amish: "i accept all your recommendations, go with them across all repos."	SLW-DDR-001, SLW-DDR-002
2026-09-25	Reference site on an existing pole, mast a site option; FieldNode asked to rate its 12 V rail; keyed switch on its own post about 5 m from the siren; precaution beacon at 1 % duty or less; own TwinKit gateway at SF12 sites	Amish, same instruction: go with recommendation	SLW-DDR-002, items 8 to 12
2026-09-30	Make the design physically buildable while drawing the build plan, keeping what the product does; changes recorded for review and accepted on 2026-10-02 (below)	Amish: "If you are realising that the design cannot be built as per concept - fix the design assumptions to match and be physically feasible as you draw the illustrations."	SLW-DDR-003 (changes open for his review)
2026-09-30	Build plan format approved; open decisions kept out of the build plan, in this register	Amish: "this is the correct build plan ... this is a good quality document format. Extend this across all the other repos"	SLW-BLD-001, SLW-DEC-001
2026-10-01	budget_usd is a hypothetical value-engineering target, not a limit; cost reported against it	Amish: "the budgets are a hypothetical control target to ensure we are thinking along a value engineering lens. its ok to ensure wording reflects that the hypothesis budget was x - the real cost being accrued is y"	This register, Value engineering; SLW-CAL-001 v0.3
2026-10-02	Design for construction accepted: the changes P1 to P11, as made	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	SLW-DDR-003, Table 1
2026-10-02	Mast factor of 1.7 on yield accepted for the prototype on a fenced test slope with no one under the mast in high wind; any site installation uses the 60.3 mm mast unless local gust data show winds well below 35 m/s	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	SLW-DDR-003, A1; SLW-CAL-001 [H2]
2026-10-02	Four wall holes are added to both back plates so the node and the alert unit can be coach-screwed to a timber pole or wall; the change is to be agreed with FieldNode	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	SLW-DDR-003, A2
2026-10-02	The optional mast is built for the first prototype	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	SLW-DDR-003, A3
2026-10-02	The problem wording "often give warning" is accepted	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	SLW-DDR-001 O1, SLW-DDR-002
2026-10-02	First co-design partner and site type to approach: an operating aggregate quarry with a geotechnical engineer on staff, testing on a	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	SLW-DDR-001 O2

Date	Decision	Decided by	Record
	bench away from the work face; a hillside community and its district disaster office only after TRL 4		
2026-10-02	A geotechnical partner sets thresholds per site before any alarm goes live; until then the published tilt-rate thresholds and the crack-gauge placeholders are used for logging only, not for public alarms	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	SLW-DDR-001 O3
2026-10-02	At sites with running machinery, a second alert unit at the work face, linked by LoRa; pagers stay a later option	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	SLW-PRC-001, open questions; SLW-CAL-001 [E3]
2026-10-02	A fault message whenever a stake stops answering; the bus runs in buried conduit where the ground allows, and armoured cable only across rockfall zones	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	SLW-PRC-001, open questions
2026-10-02	Stake heads in signal amber with a retroreflective band, a stake ID label and a downslope arrow on the crown	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	REVIEW 2026-09-26
2026-10-02	The request to FieldNode for a 12 V rail rated at least 0.5 A continuous stands; if FieldNode has not rated it before the TRL 4 build, the alert unit gets its own small battery	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	SLW-DDR-002 item 9
2026-10-02	FieldNode's candidate pinout adopted (pin 1 switched rail, pin 2 data A, pin 3 ground, pin 4 data B, pin 5 analog); SlopeWatch uses 12 V on pin 1 with the bus on pins 2 and 4, and the keyed switch input on pin 5 of port B	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	FND-DDR-001 O2